Name of the Program: Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com.)

Course Code: B.Com. 3.5

Name of the Course: Personality Development

No. of Hours per Week 2 Hrs **Total No. of Teaching Hours 32 Hrs**

Pedagogy: Classroom lectures, case studies, group discussions, seminars, field work, role plays, soft skills games, audio-visual presentations, and use of digital tools such as resume builders, LinkedIn profile creation, and mock interview platforms to ensure experiential and application-oriented learning. etc., Course Outcomes: On successful completion of the course, the Students will be able to

a) Understand personality types, assess their strengths and weaknesses, and apply goal-setting and time management techniques.

b) Monitor their behaviour, understand perception and attitude, and develop assertive communication skills.

c) Gain skills in team collaboration, leadership, negotiation, and conflict resolution using practical methods.

d) Improve communication and emotional intelligence, analyse interactions using transactional analysis, and manage stress effectively.

e) Develop professional etiquette, participate in group discussions, and prepare confidently for job interviews.

Syllabus:

Module No. 1: **Personality, Self-Awareness, SWOT & Goal Setting** Personality: Definition - Determinants - Personality Traits -Theories of Personality - Importance of Personality Development. Self-Awareness: Meaning - Benefits of Self-Awareness - Developing Self-Awareness - Use of Personality Assessment Tools. SWOT Analysis: Meaning - Importance - Application - Components. Goal Setting: Meaning - Importance - Effective Goal Setting - Principle of Goal Setting Goal Setting at the Right Level - Time Management Techniques - Overcoming Procrastination & Building Discipline.

Module No. 2: Self-Monitoring, Perception, Attitude & Assertiveness

Self-Monitoring: Meaning - High Self-Monitor vs Low Self-Monitor - Advantages and Disadvantages - Self-Monitoring and Job Performance. Perception: Definition - Factors Influencing Perception -Perception Process - Errors in Perception -Avoiding Perceptual Errors- Cognitive Biases in Decision-Making. Attitude: Meaning - Formation of Attitude -Types of Attitude - Measurement of Attitudes - Barriers to Attitude Change - Methods to Attitude Change. Assertiveness: Meaning - Assertiveness in Communication - Assertiveness Techniques - Benefits of Being Assertive - Improving Assertiveness.

Module No. 3: Team Building, Leadership, Negotiation & Conflict Management

Team Building: Meaning - Types of Teams - Importance of Team Building - Creating Effective Teams- Role Plays and Gamified Team Activities, Leadership: Definition - Leadership Styles - Theories of Leadership - Qualities of an Effective Leader - 21st Century Leadership Competencies (Agility, Empathy, Adaptability). Negotiation Skills: Meaning - Principles of Negotiation - Types of Negotiation -The Negotiation Process - Common Mistakes in Negotiation - Collaborative vs Competitive Negotiation Styles. Conflict Management: Definition -Types of Conflict -Levels of Conflict - Conflict Resolution - Conflict Management - Critical Thinking & Problem-Solving Approaches in Conflict Situations.

Module No. 4: Communication, Emotional Intelligence, Stress & Transactional Analysis

Communication: Definition - Importance of Communication -Process of Communication - Communication Symbols -Communication Network - Barriers in Communication - Overcoming Communication Barriers -Cross-Cultural and Global Communication Skills - Digital Communication Etiquette (Email, Video Calls, Chat Platforms). Transactional Analysis:

Meaning - EGO States -Types of Transactions - Johari Window - Life Positions. Emotional Intelligence: Meaning - Components of Emotional Intelligence - Significance of Managing Emotional Intelligence - How to Develop Emotional Quotient. Stress Management: Meaning - Sources of Stress - Symptoms of Stress - Consequences of Stress - Managing Stress.

Module 5: Social Graces, Group Discussion, and Interview Skills

Social Graces: Meaning - Social Grace at Work - Acquiring Social Graces - Cyber Etiquette and Online Professionalism (Social media, LinkedIn behavior). Table Manners: Meaning - Table Etiquettes in Multicultural Environment - Do's and Don'ts of Table Etiquettes. Dress Code: Meaning -Dress Code for Selected Occasions - Dress Code for an Interview - Personal Grooming and Branding Basics. Group Discussion: Meaning - Personality Traits Required for Group Discussion Process of Group Discussion - Group Discussion Topics - Evaluation Rubric for GD Practice. Interview: Definition -Types of Interviews - Skills Required - Employer Expectations - Planning for the Interview - Interview Process - Interview Questions - Critical Interview Questions - STAR Technique for Behavioral Questions - Building a Video Resume - Using AI Tools for Resume & Mock Interview Practice.

References

1. Barun K. Mitra (2011). *Personality Development and Soft Skills*. Oxford University Press, New Delhi.
2. Dr. S. Narayana Rajan, et al. (2010). *Personality Development*. Publication Division, Manonmaniam Sundaranar University, Tirunelveli.
3. Dr. K. K. Ramachandran & Dr. K. K. Karthick (2010). *From Campus to Corporate*. Macmillan Publishers India, New Delhi.
4. Dr. Shalini Verma (2016). *Development of Life Skills and Professional Practice*. Sultan Chand & Sons, New Delhi.
5. Prof. M. S. Rao (2011). *Soft Skills: Enhancing Employability and Career Growth*. I.K. International Publishing House, New Delhi.

"Your personality is the window through which others see the world inside you. Open it with confidence, polish it with discipline, and protect it with integrity." - *Salim Malik A R*

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Prepared By
Salim Malik A R **M.Com.,MBA., K-SET., B.Ed.,(Ph.D.)**
Assistant Professor & Certified Soft Skills Trainer
Department of Commerce and Management
salim10289@gmail.com
Adjunct Faculty,
ARG Arts and Commerce College,
Bhadra Institute of Management and Information Science studies,
Jnanakashi Degree College,
Davangere, Karnataka

MODULE 1:

Personality, Self-Awareness, SWOT & Goal Setting

1.1 Personality

Definition:

Personality is the set of behaviours, thoughts, emotions, and habits that make a person unique. It reflects how a person reacts, communicates, thinks, and presents themselves in different situations.

Example:

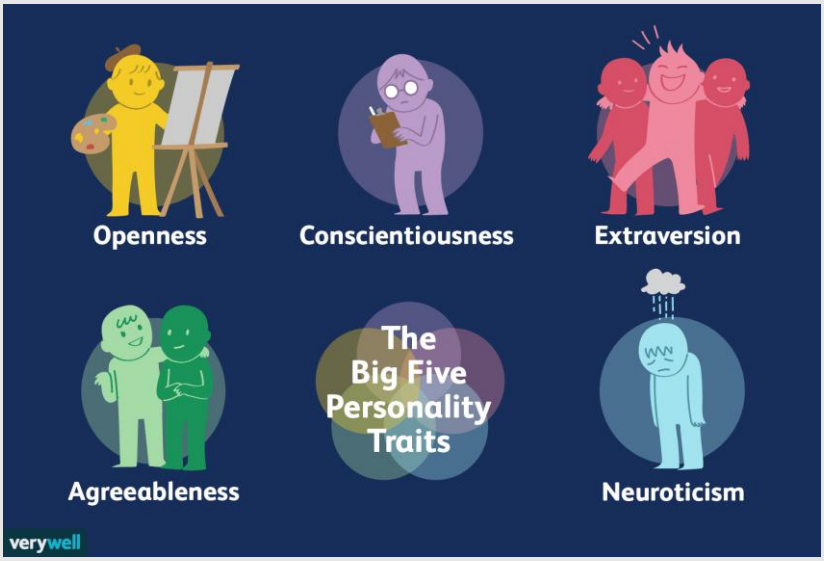
A person who is friendly, confident, and calm under pressure has a different personality compared to someone who is shy, nervous, and avoids communication.

Determinants of Personality:

1. Heredity – Traits inherited from parents such as body structure, intelligence, and temperament.
2. Environment – Social and cultural surroundings including family, school, peer groups, and media.
3. Situations – A person's behaviour may change depending on the situation. For example, someone may be quiet at home but confident in a classroom or office.

Personality Traits (Big Five):

1. Openness – Creative, curious, and open to new experiences
2. Conscientiousness – Organized, responsible, and goal-oriented
3. Extraversion – Outgoing, talkative, and energetic
4. Agreeableness – Friendly, helpful, and cooperative
5. Neuroticism – Emotionally unstable, anxious, or easily upset



Cherry, K. (2020). *The Big Five Personality Traits*. Verywell Mind.

Theories of Personality:

1. Type Theory – Classifies people into personality types like introverts and extroverts (Carl Jung).
2. Trait Theory – Focuses on specific traits that define a person's personality (Gordon Allport).
3. Psychoanalytic Theory – Emphasizes the unconscious mind and childhood experiences (Sigmund Freud).
4. Humanistic Theory – Focuses on personal growth and self-fulfilment (Abraham Maslow).

Importance of Personality Development:

1. Improves communication and social interaction
2. Builds self-confidence and motivation
3. Helps in job interviews, leadership roles, and teamwork
4. Supports emotional control and stress management

1.2 Self-Awareness

Definition:

Self-awareness is the ability to understand your own personality, emotions, behaviors, strengths, and weaknesses.

Benefits of Self-Awareness:

- Helps in setting realistic goals
- Improves decision-making and emotional control
- Builds stronger relationships
- Helps you understand how others perceive you

Ways to Develop Self-Awareness:

- Self-reflection and thinking about your own actions
- Taking feedback from others
- Using personality assessment tools like MBTI or the Johari Window
- Maintaining a personal diary or journal

Example:
If you realize you get nervous during public speaking, you can start practicing in small groups to improve confidence.

1.3 SWOT Analysis

Definition:
SWOT stands for Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats. It is a personal analysis tool that helps you understand yourself better and plan your development.

Components of SWOT:

1. **Strengths** – Skills or qualities you are good at
2. **Weaknesses** – Areas where you need improvement
3. **Opportunities** – Chances for growth and success
4. **Threats** – Challenges that may stop your progress

Example (Student SWOT):

- Strength: Good in communication
- Weakness: Poor time management

- Opportunity: College workshop on resume writing
- Threat: Tough job market



Importance of SWOT Analysis:

- Helps in personal and career planning
- Encourages self-improvement
- Makes it easier to focus on goals and reduce risks

1.4 Goal Setting

Definition:

Goal setting is the process of identifying something you want to achieve and making a plan to reach it.

Importance of Goal Setting:

1. Gives clarity and direction to life
2. Increases motivation and focus
3. Helps measure progress and success
4. Encourages discipline and planning

SMART Goal Method:

S – Specific: Clear and well-defined

M – Measurable: Can be tracked or measured

A – Achievable: Realistic and possible

R – Relevant: Matches your personal or career goals

T – Time-bound: Has a fixed deadline

Tips for Effective Goal Setting:

1. Write down your goals clearly
2. Break big goals into small steps
3. Set short-term and long-term goals
4. Review your progress regularly
5. Reward yourself for achieving small milestones

Example:

"I want to improve my spoken English by practicing 30 minutes daily for 3 months."

Time Management Techniques

Meaning:

Time management means organizing and planning how to divide your time between specific activities to work smarter, not harder.

Common Techniques:

1. Create a daily plan or schedule
2. Prioritize tasks using a to-do list
3. Use the Pomodoro technique – study for 25 minutes, take a 5-minute break
4. Avoid distractions like mobile phones or social media during work
5. Use tools like calendars, timers, or productivity apps

Benefits of Time Management:

- Reduces stress and last-minute pressure
- Increases productivity and focus
- Helps balance studies, work, and personal life
- Ensures timely completion of tasks

Overcoming Procrastination and Building Discipline

Procrastination:

Procrastination is the habit of delaying important tasks, often by doing easier or less important activities.

Reasons for Procrastination:

- Fear of failure
- Lack of motivation
- Feeling overwhelmed
- Distractions or laziness

Ways to Overcome Procrastination:

1. Start with small and easy tasks
2. Set deadlines and stick to them
3. Break big tasks into smaller parts
4. Reward yourself for completing tasks
5. Stay away from distractions while working

Building Self-Discipline:

1. Set clear daily routines
2. Focus on one task at a time
3. Be consistent with habits
4. Track your progress regularly
5. Avoid excuses and stay committed

Example:

Instead of saying "I'll study later," create a fixed time to study every day and stick to it, even if it's just 30 minutes.

Summary – Module 1

Topic	*Key Idea*
Personality	Unique behavior and traits shaped by heredity, environment, and situation

Self-Awareness	Knowing your strengths, weaknesses, and emotions
SWOT Analysis	A tool to assess yourself for growth and planning
Goal Setting	Deciding what to achieve and how to reach it
Time Management	Managing time effectively to increase productivity
Procrastination	Overcoming delay and building good habits through discipline

MODULE 2:

Self-Monitoring, Perception, Attitude & Assertiveness

2.1 Self-Monitoring

Definition:

Self-monitoring is the ability to observe and control one's own behavior, emotions, and appearance in different situations to fit social expectations.

In simple words:

It means paying attention to how you act, how others react to you, and adjusting your behavior if needed.

Types of Self-Monitors:

1. **High Self-Monitors:**
    - They are very aware of how they are seen by others.
    - They adjust their behaviour to suit the situation.
    - Example: A person who speaks politely in a formal meeting but is casual with friends.
2. **Low Self-Monitors:**
    - They act the same in all situations.
    - They are not much concerned about others' opinions.
    - Example: A person who behaves casually even during interviews.

Advantages of High Self-Monitoring:

- Better at communication and teamwork
- Easily adapt to new environments
- Good at building relationships

Disadvantages of High Self-Monitoring:

- May appear fake or less genuine
- Can be mentally exhausting

Relation with Job Performance:

High self-monitors often perform better in jobs that require social interaction like sales, customer service, or leadership roles.

2.2 Perception

Definition:

Perception is the process of interpreting and understanding the information received through the senses.

In simple words:

It is how we see, understand, and make sense of the world around us.

Factors Influencing Perception:

1. **Personal factors** – Attitude, experience, values, interests
2. **Situational factors** – Time, place, and environment
3. **Target factors** – Characteristics of the person or object being observed

Perception Process:

1. **Selection** – Choosing which information to focus on
2. **Organization** – Arranging information in a meaningful way
3. **Interpretation** – Giving meaning to the information

Errors in Perception:

1. **Stereotyping** – Judging someone based on group identity
   Example: Thinking all teenagers are lazy
2. **Halo Effect** – Forming an opinion based on one good quality
   Example: Thinking someone is intelligent just because they speak well
3. **Horn Effect** – Judging someone negatively due to one bad quality
4. **First Impression Error** – Making quick judgments without knowing the full picture
5. **Projection** – Assuming others think and feel like you do

Cognitive Biases in Decision-Making:

- **Confirmation Bias:** Only noticing information that supports your existing belief
- **Anchoring Bias:** Relying too much on the first piece of information

These biases can affect fair thinking and good decision-making.

How to Avoid Perceptual Errors:

a) Be aware of your own biases
b) Avoid jumping to conclusions
c) Collect more information before judging
d) Keep an open mind

2.3 Attitude

Definition:
Attitude is a mental state involving beliefs, feelings, and behavior toward a person, object, or situation.

In simple words:
It is how we think and feel about something, which affects how we behave.

Formation of Attitude:

a) Family and upbringing
b) Personal experiences
c) Peer influence
d) Media and culture
e) Education

Types of Attitude:

1. Positive Attitude – Optimistic, hopeful, and open-minded
2. Negative Attitude – Pessimistic, doubtful, and resistant to change

3. Neutral Attitude – Neither strong positive nor negative feelings

Measurement of Attitudes:

a) Surveys and questionnaires
b) Observation of behavior
c) Psychological tools like Likert scales

Barriers to Attitude Change:

1) Strong beliefs or habits
2) Peer pressure
3) Fear of change
4) Lack of awareness or motivation

Methods to Change Attitude:

1. Education and information – Learning new facts or perspectives
2. Experience – Direct involvement can change views
3. Communication – Persuasion by trusted sources
4. Positive reinforcement – Rewards for showing better behaviour

Example:
A student who feared public speaking may develop a positive attitude after successfully giving a class presentation.

2.4 Assertiveness

Definition:
Assertiveness is the ability to express your thoughts, feelings, and needs confidently and respectfully without being aggressive or passive.

In simple words:
It means standing up for yourself in a calm and honest way.

Assertiveness in Communication:

- Being clear and honest
- Respecting others' opinions

- Using polite but firm language
- Listening actively

Assertiveness Techniques:

1. **Using "I" Statements:** Focus on your feelings, not blaming others Example: "I feel left out when I'm not included in group work."
2. **Broken Record Technique:** Calmly repeating your point until it is heard
3. **Scripting:** Preparing what to say in advance
4. **Saying "No" Firmly:** Refusing requests without guilt

Benefits of Being Assertive:

1) Builds self-respect and confidence
2) Improves communication and relationships
3) Helps reduce stress and anxiety
4) Encourages honest and respectful conversations

How to Improve Assertiveness:

a) Practice speaking clearly and confidently
b) Maintain eye contact and good posture
c) Set healthy boundaries
d) Learn to say "no" without feeling guilty

Difference between Assertive, Passive, and Aggressive Behavior:

Type	Description	Example
Passive	Avoids expressing needs or opinions	Not speaking up even when treated unfairly
Aggressive	Forceful, disrespectful communication	Yelling or threatening to get your way
Assertive	Honest and respectful communication	Calmly expressing disagreement

Summary

Topic	***Key Ideas***
Self-Monitoring	Observing and adjusting your behavior based on the situation
Perception	Understanding how we interpret people and situations
Attitude	Our feelings and beliefs that shape our behavior
Assertiveness	Expressing oneself confidently without hurting others

MODULE 3:

Team Building, Leadership, Negotiation & Conflict Management

3.1 Team Building

Definition:

Team building is the process of creating a group of individuals who work together effectively to achieve common goals.

In simple words:

It means forming a team and helping its members work together in a friendly and productive way.

Types of Teams:

1. Formal Teams – Created by an organization with a clear structure andgoals
   Example: Project team in a company
2. Informal Teams – Naturally formed by people with common interests
   Example: A group of friends working together on a college event
3. Cross-functional Teams – Members from different departments or areas
   Example: Marketing, Finance, and HR working together
4. Virtual Teams – Teams that work online or remotely
   Example: A remote customer support team

Importance of Team Building:

a) Encourages cooperation and trust
b) Improves communication
c) Increases productivity and creativity
d) Reduces conflicts and misunderstandings
e) Builds a sense of belonging and motivation

Creating Effective Teams:

1. Clear goals and roles for each member

2. Open and honest communication
3. Respect for different opinions
4. Good leadership and support
5. Encouraging participation from all members

Team Building Activities:

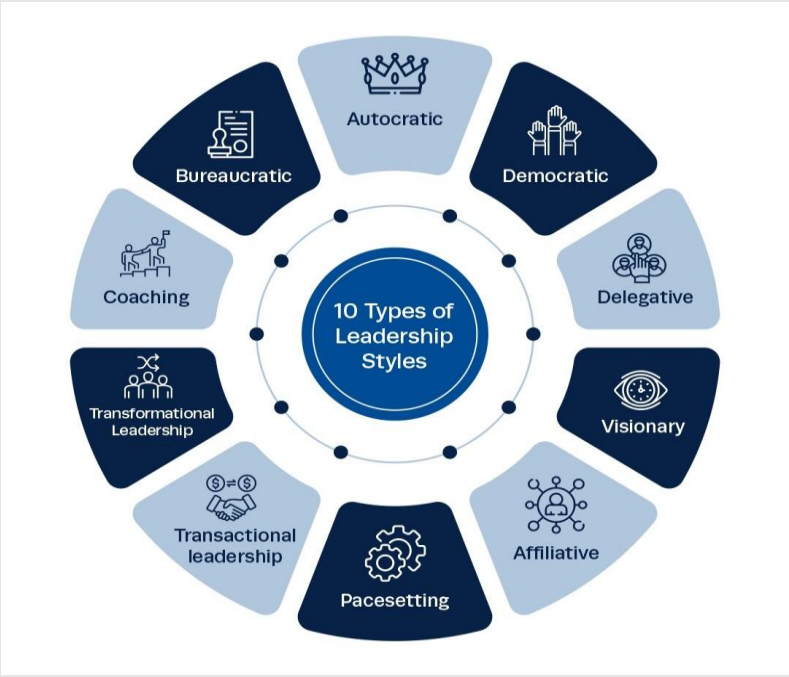
a) Role plays
b) Case studies
c) Gamified activities like puzzles or challenges
d) Group tasks and outdoor exercises

3.2 Leadership

Definition:
Leadership is the ability to influence, guide, and motivate others to achieve a common goal.

In simple words:
A leader is someone who shows the way, supports the team, and helps them succeed.

Leadership Styles:



Types of Leadership Styles", *AIHR – Academy to Innovate HR*

1. Autocratic–Leader takes decisions alone
   Example: Military leadership
2. Democratic–Leader involves team in decision-making
   Example: A project leader who takes suggestions from the group
3. Laissez-faire–Leader gives freedom to team members
   Example: Creative industries like advertising or design
4. Transformational–Leader inspires and brings change
   Example: A leader who motivates the team to achieve more than expected
5. Transactional – Leader rewards or punishes based on performance
   Example: A sales manager giving bonuses for targets

Theories of Leadership:

1. Trait Theory – Leaders are born with special traits (confidence, intelligence)
2. Behavioral Theory – Leadership is learned through behavior and practice
3. Situational Theory – Leadership style depends on the situation and team

Qualities of an Effective Leader:

a) Clear vision and strong communication
b) Confidence and decision-making ability
c) Empathy and emotional intelligence
d) Integrity and honesty
e) Ability to motivate and support others

21st Century Leadership Competencies:

- Agility – Quick and flexible decision-making
- Empathy – Understanding others' feelings
- Adaptability – Adjusting to change and uncertainty
- Technological awareness – Using digital tools to lead

3.3 Negotiation Skills

Definition:

Negotiation is the process where two or more people discuss and reach an agreement that benefits all parties.

In simple words:

It is a way of solving problems or making deals by talking and compromising.

Principles of Negotiation:

1. Prepare before the negotiation
2. Focus on interests, not positions
3. Create a win-win situation
4. Be respectful and professional
5. Communicate clearly and listen actively

Types of Negotiation:

1. **Distributive Negotiation** – One person's gain is another's loss (win-lose)
   Example: Bargaining at a shop
2. **Integrative Negotiation** – Both sides gain something (win-win)
   Example: Business partnerships

Negotiation Process:

1. **Preparation** – Know your goals, facts, and the other party's needs
2. **Opening** – Start the discussion politely and professionally
3. **Discussion** – Share ideas, offers, and concerns
4. **Bargaining** – Make offers and find compromises
5. **Closing** – Agree on final terms
6. **Implementation** – Follow through on the agreement

Common Mistakes in Negotiation:

- Getting emotional or angry

- Not preparing properly
- Being too aggressive or too passive
- Ignoring the other person's needs

Collaborative vs Competitive Negotiation:

Type	Meaning	Focus
Collaborative	Win-win situation	Cooperation and mutual benefit
Competitive	Win-lose approach	Focus only on personal gain

3.4 Conflict Management

Definition:

Conflict management is the process of handling disagreements or arguments between individuals or groups in a peaceful and constructive way.

Types of Conflict:

1. Intrapersonal –Conflict within oneself
   Example: Confusion about choosing a career
2. Interpersonal –Conflict between two people
   Example: Disagreement between classmates
3. Intragroup – Conflict within a group or team
   Example: Team members not agreeing on a plan
4. Intergroup – Conflict between two groups
   Example: Two departments arguing over project control

Levels of Conflict:

a) Low – Characterized by isolated incidents such as minor misunderstandings, occasional disagreements, or differences in opinion that are easily resolved and do not cause lasting tension.
b) Medium – Involves more frequent or persistent issues, such as regular disagreements, ongoing communication breakdowns, or unresolved issues that start to affect relationships or productivity

c) High – This level includes serious fights, ongoing tension, hostility, or potentially harmful situations that require significant intervention to resolve.

Conflict Resolution Techniques:

1. Avoiding – Ignoring the issue (not suitable for serious problems)
2. Accommodating – Giving in to maintain peace
3. Competing – Trying to win at any cost
4. Compromising – Each side gives up something
5. Collaborating – Working together to find a solution

Conflict Management Skills:

a) Stay calm and respectful
b) Listen actively to all sides
c) Focus on facts, not emotions
d) Use clear and polite communication
e) Look for solutions, not blame

Critical Thinking in Conflict Situations

a) Analyze the problem logically
b) Understand all sides of the issue
c) Separate facts from opinions
d) Think of long-term impact, not just quick fixes

Problem-Solving Approaches:

1. Define the problem clearly
2. Identify possible solutions
3. Evaluate pros and cons
4. Choose the best solution
5. Implement and review

Summary – Module 3

Topic	***Key Ideas***
Team Building	Creating a group that works well together with trust and cooperation
Leadership	Guiding and motivating others toward a common goal
Negotiation	Reaching a fair agreement through discussion and compromise
Conflict Management	Handling disagreements with calmness, respect, and logic

MODULE 4:

Communication, Emotional Intelligence, Stress & Transactional Analysis

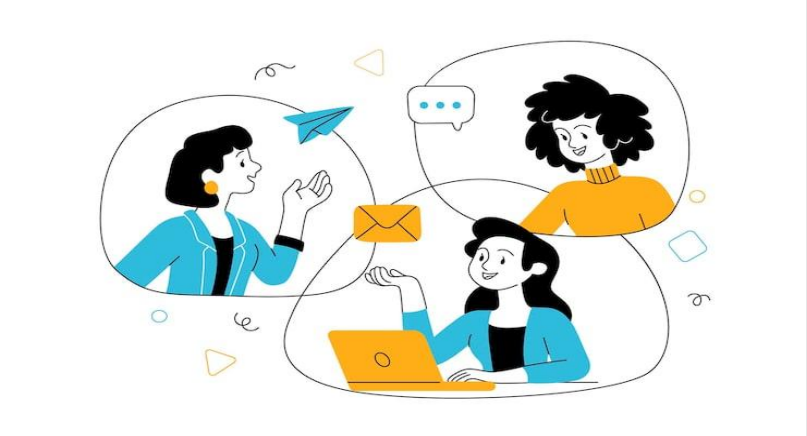
4.1 Communication

Definition:

Communication is the process of exchanging information, ideas, thoughts, and feelings between people through words, symbols, or actions.

In simple words:

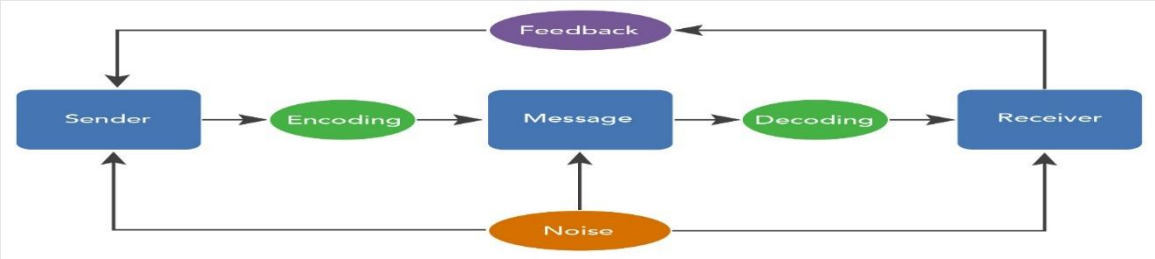
It is how we talk, listen, write, and understand each other.



Importance of Communication:

- Builds relationships and teamwork
- Helps in sharing ideas clearly
- Essential for leadership and decision-making
- Important in interviews, business, and customer service

Process of Communication:



Shannon–Weaver Model or the **Linear Communication Model**

1. **Sender** – The person who starts the message
2. **Message** – The information to be shared
3. **Medium/Channel** – The method used (spoken, written, digital, etc.)
4. **Receiver** – The person who receives the message
5. **Feedback** – Response from the receiver
6. **Noise** – Any disturbance that affects the message (physical or emotional)

Communication Symbols:

a) Verbal Symbols: Words and language
b) Non-Verbal Symbols: Body language, facial expressions, gestures
c) Visual Symbols**:** Charts, graphs, signs

Communication Network:

- **Formal Communication:** Follows organizational structure (emails, reports)
- **Informal Communication:** Casual talks (friendly chats, social media)

Barriers to Communication:

1. Language differences
2. Cultural misunderstandings
3. Emotional disturbances
4. Poor listening skills
5. Physical distractions (noise, poor internet)

Overcoming Communication Barriers:

- Use simple and clear language
- Listen actively and patiently
- Avoid assumptions and clarify doubts
- Choose the right medium
- Be culturally sensitive and respectful

Cross-Cultural and Global Communication Skills:

- ✓ Be aware of cultural differences (greetings, body language)
- ✓ Use polite and inclusive language
- ✓ Avoid slang or local expressions
- ✓ Respect different communication styles

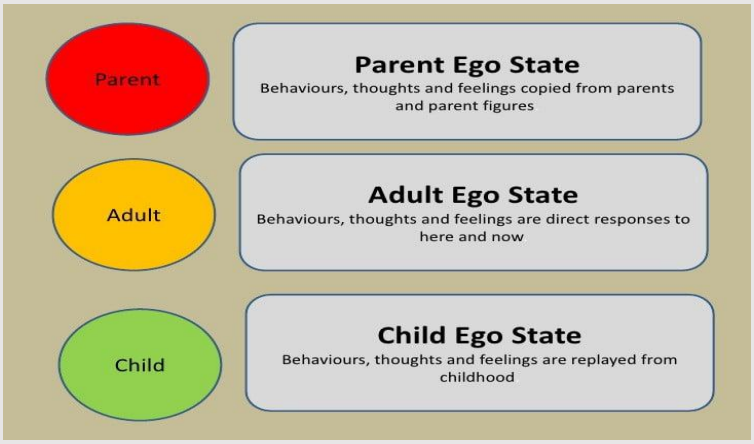
Digital Communication Etiquette:

a) Be professional in emails and messages
b) Use respectful language during video calls
c) Don't interrupt during online meetings
d) Avoid using ALL CAPS (it looks like shouting)
e) Respond on time to professional messages

4.2 Transactional Analysis

Definition:

Transactional Analysis (TA) is a psychological method that studies interactions (transactions) between people based on their behavior and communication.



Transactional Analysis Theory & Therapy: Dr.Eric Berne

EGO States in TA:

1. Parent: Behaves like a teacher or authority figure
   Example: "You should not be late."

2. Adult: Thinks logically and acts based on facts
   Example: “Let’s plan and see what works best.”
3. Child**:** Shows emotions and instincts
   Example: “I don’t want to do this!”

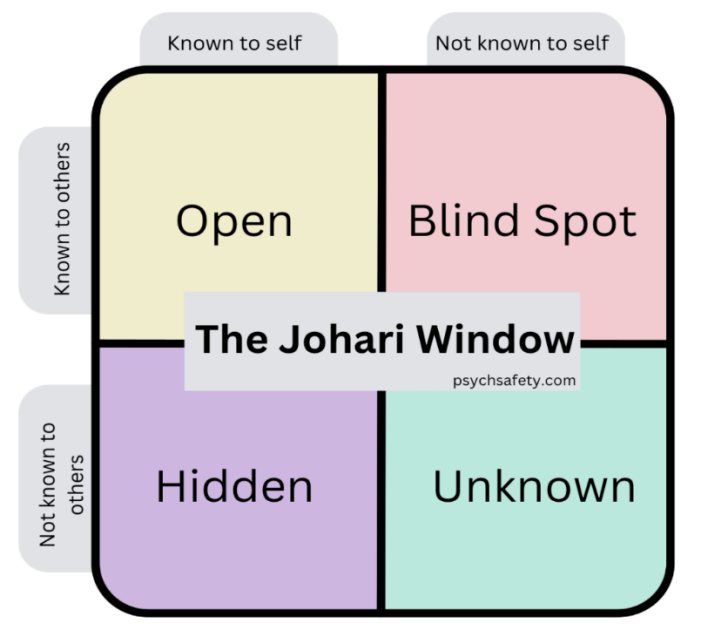
Types of Transactions:

1. **Complementary Transaction:** Communication matches EGO states
   Example: Parent to Child, Child to Parent – smooth interaction
2. **Crossed Transaction:** Mismatch in EGO states – causes confusion orconflict
   Example: One speaks logically (Adult), other reacts emotionally (Child)
3. **Ulterior Transaction:** Hidden messages behind words
   Example: Saying something polite but meaning something else

Johari Window:

A model to improve self-awareness and communication

1. Open Area: Known to self and others
2. Hidden Area: Known to self, not to others
3. Blind Spot: Unknown to self, known to others
4. Unknown Area**:** Unknown to self and others



Life Positions:



1. **I'm OK – You're OK** (Healthy position)
2. **I'm OK – You're not OK** (Dominating)
3. **I'm not OK – You're OK** (Low self-esteem)
4. **I'm not OK – You're not OK** (Negative mindset)

4.3 Emotional Intelligence

Definition:

Emotional Intelligence (EI) is the ability to understand, manage, and express your emotions, as well as to recognize and influence the emotions of others.

In simple words:

It means being smart with your feelings.

Components of Emotional Intelligence:

1. Self-Awareness – Knowing your emotions
2. Self-Regulation – Controlling your emotions
3. Motivation – Staying positive and driven
4. Empathy – Understanding others' feelings
5. Social Skills – Communicating and managing relationships

Significance of Emotional Intelligence:

- Helps build trust and teamwork
- Improves leadership skills
- Reduces stress and conflict
- Helps in handling criticism and feedback
- Increases overall personal and professional success

How to Develop Emotional Quotient (EQ):

- ✓ Reflect on your feelings daily
- ✓ Pause before reacting emotionally
- ✓ Listen with empathy
- ✓ Practice mindfulness and relaxation
- ✓ Accept feedback and learn from it

Example:
A team leader who stays calm during a crisis and motivates the team is emotionally intelligent.

4.4 Stress Management

Definition:
Stress is the physical or emotional pressure a person feels when they are overwhelmed by demands or challenges.

Sources of Stress:

- Academic pressure and exams
- Deadlines and workload
- Family or relationship problems
- Financial difficulties
- Health issues

Symptoms of Stress:

i. Physical: Headaches, tiredness, sleep problems
ii. Emotional: Anxiety, sadness, anger

iii. Behavioral: Irritability, avoiding people, eating too much or too little

Consequences of Stress:

a) Poor concentration
b) Low academic performance
c) Conflicts with others
d) Health problems like high blood pressure

Managing Stress:

1. Time Management: Plan your schedule and avoid last-minute work
2. Exercise: Helps release stress and improve mood
3. Healthy Lifestyle: Eat well, sleep well, and avoid harmful habits
4. Relaxation Techniques: Deep breathing, meditation, yoga
5. Talk to Someone: Share with a friend, family member, or counselor
6. Positive Thinking**:** Focus on solutions, not just problems

Example:

If exams are causing stress, making a study timetable and taking short breaks can help reduce pressure.

Summary – Module 4

Topic	***Key Ideas***
Communication	Exchanging information clearly using verbal, non-verbal, and digital methods
Transactional Analysis	Understanding interactions through Parent, Adult, and Child ego states
Emotional Intelligence	Recognizing and managing your emotions and the emotions of others
Stress Management	Identifying sources of stress and using healthy techniques to manage it

MODULE 5:

Social Graces, Group Discussion, and Interview Skills

5.1 Social Graces

Definition:
Social graces are polite and respectful behaviors that help people interact well in society and in professional environments.

In simple words:
They are good manners and proper behavior in public or workplace settings.

Social Graces at Work:

- Being punctual
- Greeting others politely
- Saying “please,” “thank you,” and “sorry” when needed
- Respecting personal space
- Being a good listener

Acquiring Social Graces:

a) Observe others with good manners
b) Practice respectful language and behavior
c) Be open to feedback and correction

- Learn about cultural and workplace etiquette

Example:
Standing up to greet someone, holding the door for others, or saying “excuse me” when interrupting.

5.2 Cyber Etiquette and Online Professionalism

Cyber Etiquette:
Also called **netiquette**, it means using respectful and responsible behavior while communicating online.

Online Professionalism Includes:

a) Using polite language in emails, messages, and posts
b) Avoiding the use of all capital letters (which seems like shouting)
c) Not spreading fake news or offensive content
d) Respecting others' privacy online
e) Being careful about what you post on social media

LinkedIn Behavior:

A. Use a professional profile photo
B. Write a clear and honest summary
C. Connect with people respectfully
D. Avoid commenting negatively or posting unrelated content

Example:
When applying for a job, your employer might check your social media profile. Being professional online creates a good impression.

5.3 Table Manners

Definition:
Table manners are the polite behaviours you follow while eating, especially in formal or multicultural settings.

Importance in Professional Settings:

- Shows respect and discipline
- Reflects your upbringing and personality
- Helps during business lunches or interviews

Meaning of Etiquette:

Etiquette refers to the set of rules, manners, and socially accepted behaviours that guide how individuals behave in different situations especially in professional, social, and formal settings.

Example:

- Saying “please” and “thank you”
- Not interrupting when someone is speaking
- Dressing properly for an interview
- Using polite language in email

Do’s	Don’ts
Sit upright and avoid placing elbows on the table	Don’t talk with food in your mouth
Wait for everyone before starting the meal	Don’t make noise while eating (e.g., slurping, loud chewing)
Use cutlery properly and follow dining manners	Don’t use your phone at the table
Chew with your mouth closed	
Say “excuse me” politely if you need to leave the table	

Multicultural Awareness:

Different cultures may have different eating habits. Understanding and respecting them is important in global workplaces.

5.4 Dress Code and Personal Grooming

Dress Code:

A set of rules about what clothing is suitable for different occasions, especially in professional environments.

Types of Dress Code:

1. **Formal Wear:** Used for interviews, presentations, and corporate events
2. **Business Casual:** Less formal but still neat – used in everyday office settings
3. **Casual:** For informal events or college settings (must still be decent)

Dress Code for Interviews:

- Clean and ironed clothes
- Formal shirts, trousers, and shoes for men
- Formal suits, kurtis, or sarees for women
- Minimal accessories and light perfumes

Personal Grooming:

Taking care of your appearance and hygiene.

Grooming Tips:

1. Regular bathing and use of deodorant
2. Clean, trimmed nails and neat hair
3. Avoid excessive makeup or jewelry
4. Polished shoes and well-fitted clothes

Personal Branding:

How you present yourself in public – includes your dress, behavior, and online image.

5.5 Group Discussion (GD)

Definition:

A group discussion is a structured conversation where participants express their ideas and opinions on a given topic within a time limit.

Purpose:

Used in placements, entrance exams, and job interviews to check communication, thinking, and leadership skills.

Personality Traits Required for GD:

- Confidence
- Clear and logical thinking
- Active listening
- Team spirit
- Respect for others' views

Process of Group Discussion:

1. Topic is given
2. Participants are given time to think
3. Discussion begins (each member contributes)
4. The group may try to reach a conclusion
5. Observers or evaluators give feedback

Types of Topics:

- Current affairs (e.g., Digital India)
- Abstract topics (e.g., Silence speaks louder than words)
- Case-based topics (solve a given problem)

Evaluation Rubric (Criteria):

1. Content and ideas
2. Communication skills
3. Team coordination
4. Body language
5. Time management

Tips for Success:

- Start or conclude the discussion if possible
- Be respectful and calm
- Support your points with examples
- Avoid interrupting others

5.6 Interview Skills

Definition:
An interview is a formal conversation between a job applicant and employer to assess if the person is suitable for the job.

Types of Interviews:

1. Personal Interview – One-on-one discussion

2. Panel Interview – Multiple interviewers
3. Telephonic/Video Interview – Conducted remotely
4. Group Interview – Several candidates interviewed together
5. Behavioural Interview – Focuses on past experiences and actions

Skills Required for Interviews:

Communication and body language
Listening and understanding questions
Clarity of thought and confidence
Knowledge of the subject and company

Employer Expectations:

Professional appearance and punctuality
Honesty and self-awareness
Willingness to learn and work in a team
Understanding of the role and organization

Planning for the Interview:

Research the company and job role
Prepare answers for common questions
Practice mock interviews
Dress appropriately

Common Interview Questions:

Tell me about yourself
Why should we hire you?
What are your strengths and weaknesses?
Where do you see yourself in 5 years?

Critical Interview Questions:
Use the **STAR Technique** for behavioural questions:

S – Situation
T – Task

A – Action

R – Result

Example:

Q: "Describe a time you solved a problem in a team."

A: Use STAR to explain what happened, what you did, and the result.

Using AI Tools for Resume & Interview Practice:

- Online resume builders (Canva, Zety, etc.)
- Mock interview platforms (AI-based apps)
- LinkedIn Learning for skill building

Video Resume:

A short video where you introduce yourself and highlight your skills. It adds value to your job application.

Video Resume Applications

1. Canva
2. Biteable
3. InVideo
4. Big Interview
5. Zety
6. YouTube (Unlisted *Video Option)*
7. Animoto

Summary – Module 5

Topic	***Key Ideas***
Social Graces	Good manners and behavior in society and work
Cyber Etiquette	Being professional and respectful in online communication
Table Manners	Following polite behavior while eating, especially in formal settings
Dress Code & Grooming	Wearing appropriate clothes and maintaining personal hygiene
Group Discussion	A test of communication, leadership, and thinking skills in a group
Interview Skills	Preparing and performing well in job interviews with confidence and clarity

MODEL QUESTION PAPER – 1

B.COM. 3rd Semester
Personality Development

Time: 2 Hours **Max. Marks: 40**

Section-A

Answer any five sub-questions. Each question carries 2 marks. (05 × 02 = 10 marks)

1. a) Define personality.
   b) What is SWOT analysis?
   c) Mention two types of attitude.
   d) What is assertive communication?
   e) List any two qualities of a good leader.
   f) What is a video resume?
   g) Write two cyber etiquettes.

Section – B

Answer any six questions. Each question carries 5 marks. (06 × 05 = 30 marks)

2. Explain the determinants of personality with examples.
3. Describe the benefits of self-awareness and how to develop it.
4. What are perceptual errors? Explain any three with examples.
5. Differentiate between assertive, passive, and aggressive communication.
6. Explain the importance of team building and types of teams.
7. Define negotiation. Explain its process with an example.
8. What is emotional intelligence? Explain its components.
9. Describe five essential interview skills for job success.

End of Paper

MODEL QUESTION PAPER – 2

B.COM. 3rd Semester

Personality Development

Time: 2 Hours **Max. Marks: 40**

Section-A

Answer any five sub-questions. Each question carries 2 marks. (05 × 02 = 10 marks)

1. a) What is self-monitoring?
   b) Define perception.
   c) List two time management techniques.
   d) Mention two stress symptoms.
   e) What is the STAR technique?
   f) What is transactional analysis?
   g) Write any two group discussion traits.

Section-B

Answer any six questions. Each question carries 5 marks. (06 × 05 = 30 marks)

2. Explain the importance of goal setting and principles of SMART goals.
3. What are the different types of conflicts? Explain with examples.
4. Discuss the Johari Window model and its relevance to communication.
5. Describe the leadership styles and qualities of a 21st-century leader.
6. Explain how to manage stress using practical techniques.
7. What is group discussion? Write the process and key evaluation criteria.
8. Discuss professional dress code and grooming tips for interviews.
9. Explain table manners and the do’s and don’ts of formal dining.

End of Paper